Edda the Egret and the Dawn Song

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.

Kids Book Videos



At the edge of a sleepy marsh, where tall reeds whispered in the evening breeze, lived Edda the egret — the youngest of her flock. She was soft-white all over, with long legs for wading and a beak like a yellow pencil.



Every night, the marsh held a song circle. The frogs plink-plonked from their lily pads. The crickets sawed their tiny violins. And the nightingale — oh, the nightingale poured out ribbons of silver song that made the moon lean closer to listen.



Edda loved the song circle more than anything. She loved it so much that one evening she tucked her wings neatly, lifted her beak to the stars, and sang too.

"KRAAK!"



It came out loud and croaky, like a rusty gate. The nightingale stopped mid-trill. The crickets missed a note. Edda folded her long neck down and hid her beak under her wing. Her voice was all wrong for the song circle.



Old Tessa the turtle paddled over. "What a big, brave voice," Tessa said with a slow smile. "The marsh is lucky to have it."



Edda wanted to believe her, but she wasn't sure. So that night, while everyone else was singing, Edda slipped away to the far side of the pond and practised all by herself. Kraak. Kraak-kraak. Only the bullfrogs blinked at her.



The next evening, she tried once more. She waited for the sweetest, softest part of the song and sang. Her KRAAK crashed into the nightingale's trill like a pebble into a still pond. Everything went quiet.

Edda's heart felt heavy as a stone. She spread her wings and flew off into the dark, tears shining like dewdrops on her feathers.



As the night grew deep, the song circle grew sleepy. The frogs yawned their plinks. The crickets slowed their saws. One by one, the singers drifted off to sleep.

But someone had to wake the sun in the morning — and everyone was asleep.



At the first blush of dawn, Edda stood tall on the tallest tussock, stretched her long neck to the pinkening sky, and took the deepest breath of her life.

"KRAAK-KRAAK!"

Her big, brave call rang across the marsh. It woke the reeds, the lilies, and the sleepy sun, which peeked over the hills and smiled.



The choir woke smiling too. The nightingale trilled her thanks, and the frogs plinked a welcome. From that morning on, Edda's dawn call opened the marsh's song every day — the first note, exactly as croaky and wonderful as she was.

That night, Edda curled into the soft reeds and listened to the song circle hum around her. She didn't need to sound like anyone else. She was the dawn song.

Sleep now, little Edda.

The end.

The End